An incredulous Palit then asked Bhupinder if he was aware of the overall disposition of the Bomdila defences. Bhupinder replied that he was.

'As the DMO, Army Headquarters, in the absence of the brigade commander, I authorize you to assume command of 48 Brigade.' The DMO went on to say that two battalions of 67 Brigade—3 JAK Rifles and 6/8 Gorkha Rifles—were moving up even as they were speaking and that Bhupinder Singh was to organize the defence of Bomdila to the best of his ability. Should he find the situation in Bomdila untenable, he was authorized to fall back on Tenga and hold that position. The order was acknowledged and Bhupinder Singh said he would do his best.

Darkness had begun to creep in on Bomdila. 1 Madras was still completely isolated, and the Chinese too seemed to have hunkered down for the night, in all probability reorganizing their various scattered sub-units. Around this time, Darshan Khullar recalls: 'It was nearing dusk by then with just a few minutes of light remaining, when suddenly I heard a series of shouts which turned out to be the battle-cry of the Dogra troops of 3 JAK Rif who were marching into Bomdila. The cheerleader was a stalwart JCO with a gold tooth, who straightaway asked me "Chini kahan hai? (Where are the Chinese?)"'

Lieutenant Colonel Gurdial Singh, who had surprisingly failed to meet Brigadier Gurbax Singh on his way up to Bomdila from Tenga, was commanding 3 JAK Rif. The battalion was most dismayed to find the town nearly abandoned, and with darkness setting in, there was nothing much that could be done on unfamiliar ground. After a discussion with Bhupinder Singh, the two officers decided they would await the arrival of the Gorkhas and launch a counter-attack in the early morning with the aim of recapturing the forward defences that had previously been held by 1 Sikh LI.